

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 468

By Briggs

A RESOLUTION to honor Bryan Merritt of the Tennessee State Employees Association on the occasion of his retirement.

WHEREAS, it is appropriate for this General Assembly to honor those citizens who have performed with devotion and enthusiasm throughout their careers in the public sector; and

WHEREAS, Bryan Merritt has served Tennessee State Employees Association (TSEA) with distinction in many roles during the last twenty-four years, and he is now taking his much-deserved retirement; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Merritt began his tenure with State government in March 2000 as an employee of the Department of Human Services and spent most of his eighteen years with the department working as a field supervisor in Unicoi, Washington, and Carter counties; and

WHEREAS, after joining TSEA in 2001, he became active in the Appalachian chapter of the organization, serving as its president, vice president, and TEAM local coordinator at various times; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Merritt rendered astute service as TSEA's District 11 director from 2009 to 2014, and during his time in that office, he was also active in TEAM PAC, serving as the chair of the TEAM administrative committee in 2013; and

WHEREAS, in each of these positions, Mr. Merritt displayed his dedication to State employees and his unwavering belief in their work and in TSEA's mission; and

WHEREAS, he was honored as a Rising Star by TSEA in 2010 and inducted into its Hall of Fame in 2011; and

WHEREAS, he reached the highest echelon of TSEA when he began his nine-year tenure on the organization's board of directors in 2009; he later accepted the ultimate leadership role as TSEA's board president, serving in that office from 2015 to 2018; and

WHEREAS, after completing his outstanding term on the Board of Directors in 2018, he served as TSEA's East Tennessee field representative until his retirement; and

WHEREAS, during his years with TSEA, Bryan Merritt won the respect and admiration of government professionals across the State of Tennessee, who appreciated his visionary leadership on behalf of all State employees; and

WHEREAS, he was also highly regarded on Capitol Hill; Lieutenant Governor Ron Ramsey feels that working with Mr. Merritt was "a true honor" and relied on "his unwavering support and trust in his word," also praising his "integrity and deep commitment to State employees"; and

WHEREAS, a native of Knoxville who now lives in Erwin, Bryan Merritt is the son of Max and Annette Merritt and the brother of Amy O'Dell; and

WHEREAS, he lettered in band and soccer at Halls High School, from which he graduated in 1988, and earned a Bachelor of Science degree in Psychology from the University of Tennessee at Chattanooga in 1995; and

WHEREAS, during his retirement, Bryan Merritt looks forward to spending more time with his family, especially his wife, Allison Merritt, his son, Benjamin Merritt, and his dogs; and

WHEREAS, he is eagerly anticipating rocking out to the sounds of the 1980s with the Breakfast Club whenever the mood strikes him and enjoying breakfast with his many friends around the counter at the Dari Ace in Erwin on a regular basis; and

WHEREAS, throughout his estimable career, Bryan Merritt demonstrated the utmost professionalism, ability, and integrity, winning the unbridled respect and admiration of his

colleagues, the members of the Tennessee State Employees Association, and this General Assembly; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor Bryan Merritt of the Tennessee State Employees Association on the occasion of his retirement and extend to him our heartfelt wishes for every continued happiness and success in his future endeavors.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.